Balaji Leninrajan

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Education

University of Waterloo 2023 – Present
Bachelor of Software Engineering *Waterloo, ON, Canada*
Coursework: Operating Systems, Compilers, Computer Networks, Distributed Systems, Databases, FPGA Design

Experience

Finta | Software Engineering Intern *May 2026 – Present*
- **Reduced dashboard load time by over 98%**, from approximately 2 minutes to under 2 seconds, by replacing request-time aggregation with indexed PostgreSQL read models and rebuilding the interface in React
- Built a collaborative financial-modeling spreadsheet in **three weeks**, enabling finance teams to create live models from company accounting data using custom formulas, charts, templates, and version history
- Architected Google Sheets–style **real-time collaboration** using a revisioned operation log, optimistic concurrency, WebSocket synchronization, reconnect recovery, and conflict-safe version restoration

Shopify | Production Engineering Intern | Edge Infrastructure *September 2025 – December 2025*
- Engineered a high-scale SSL stack with **Ruby on Rails** and **Terraform**; migrated 10+ services to the new stack
- Resolved a **critical production outage** caused by 429-error spikes; Implemented kill switches and refactored core retry logic with intelligent backoffs to maintain site reliability
- Recovered **$250,000+ annually** with an optimized maintenance task to **prune 10M+ dead hostnames efficiently**
- Authored operational playbooks and built **automated incident response tools** to find and fix domain and ssl job processing errors across edge infrastructure

Shopify | Software Engineering Intern | Communications Platform Team *January 2025 – April 2025*
- Shipped features for a high-throughput communications platform using **React**, **Ruby on Rails**, and **GraphQL**, orchestrating **4M+ monthly** emails and push notifications across multiple Shopify services and teams
- Designed an approval workflow system for emails using a **polymorphic Rails concern** that empowers users in marketing automation, resulting in an **80% reduction** in faulty campaigns due to human error

Waterloo Aerial Robotics Group | Autonomy Lead *January 2024 – Present*
- Led a team of **15+ software developers** that contributed to back-to-back victories at AEAC 2024 and 2025
- Architected a robust **VSLAM pipeline for autonomous drone navigation,** integrating stereo-depth sensing and visual-inertial odometry (VIO) to ensure precise localization in GPS-denied environments
- Architected a fault-tolerant **ROS 2 behavior-tree mission controller** that sequences takeoff, timed waypoint laps, target reconnaissance, and landing while preserving progress through operator kill-switch interruptions
- Built and published a **Python** developer CLI using Git sparse checkout and dependency resolution to automatically configure, run, test, and diagnose individual robotics subsystems

Projects

Maram | *Rust, Git*
- Built a **Rust-based Git workflow engine** to eliminate context-switching overhead, automating the orchestration of parallel worktree "sets" for concurrent feature development
- Implemented **conflict-aware synchronization logic** using git2-rs to automate commit propagation (cherry-picking) and rebase management across divergent worktree variants
- Designed a **custom state-management layer** that persists Worktree metadata, allowing for recursive root-discovery and seamless CLI interactions across complex project hierarchies

Linguini | *TypeScript, React, Next.js, tRPC, Tailwind, PostgreSQL*
- Shipped a full-stack multiplayer word-guessing platform using **Next.js, tRPC, and PostgreSQL**
- Created a semantic word-validation engine leveraging **PostgreSQL Recursive CTEs** to traverse hierarchical category graphs, enabling complex, multi-level word-to-category matching
- Architected a type-safe communication layer with **tRPC**, ensuring seamless state synchronization between a **responsive React frontend** and the backend for a low-latency game loop

ShowerScribe | *Flask, Python, Bootstrap, SQL, HTML/CSS, Raspberry Pi*
- Engineered an **AI-powered voice assistant** on Raspberry Pi for hands-free, intelligent note-taking
- Developed a **Flask web portal** to provide a centralized interface for organizing and playing back recordings
- Scripted a **Bash orchestration suite** to automate service initialization and optimize boot times for rapid startup
- Integrated Cohere LLM services for **automated summarization**, AI brainstorming, and **semantic search**

Technical Skills

Languages: Python, C, C++, Go, Ruby, Rust, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL
Technologies: Ruby on Rails, React, React Native, Next.js, Django, GraphQL, Tailwind, Apache Spark
Nginx, Terraform, Git, Linux, AWS, GCP, Raspberry Pi, PyTorch, Pandas, Docker, Kubernetes